

Conceptual art

Arising from Duchamp's flouting of the rules of art, the term Conceptual art was first used by American artist Sol Lewitt (1928–2007) in a 1967 article in *Artforum* magazine. It generally describes artworks in which concepts are more important than traditional aesthetic and material concerns.

Conceptualism is an umbrella term that covers several types of art, including Performance, installations, Video art, Land art, Arte Povera and others. A reaction against the emotionalism of Abstract Expressionism, it was detached and analytical, questioning assumptions about the role of art and museums, and the function of artists. Many Conceptual artists used writing rather than visual creations, while others used photography, film, video and other non-traditional materials to create their broad and disparate ideas. Those involved included: Joseph Kosuth (b.1945), Piero Manzoni (1933–63), Rauschenberg, Ad Reinhardt, John Baldessari (b.1931), and Gilbert & George, or Gilbert Prousch (b.1943) and George Passmore (b.1942).

Language (læˈŋɡwɛdʒ), *sb.* ME. [a. F. *langage* :—pop.L. type **linguaticum*, f. *lingua* tongue, language (F. *langue*; see LANGUAGE). The *u* is after F. *langue*.] 1. The whole body of words and of methods of combining them used by a nation, people, or race; a 'tongue'. b. *transf.* Method of expression otherwise than by words 1606. 2. *gen.* Words and the methods of combining them for the expression of thought 1599. b. Faculty of speech; ability to speak a foreign tongue. Now *rare*, 1526. 3. Manner or style of expression ME.